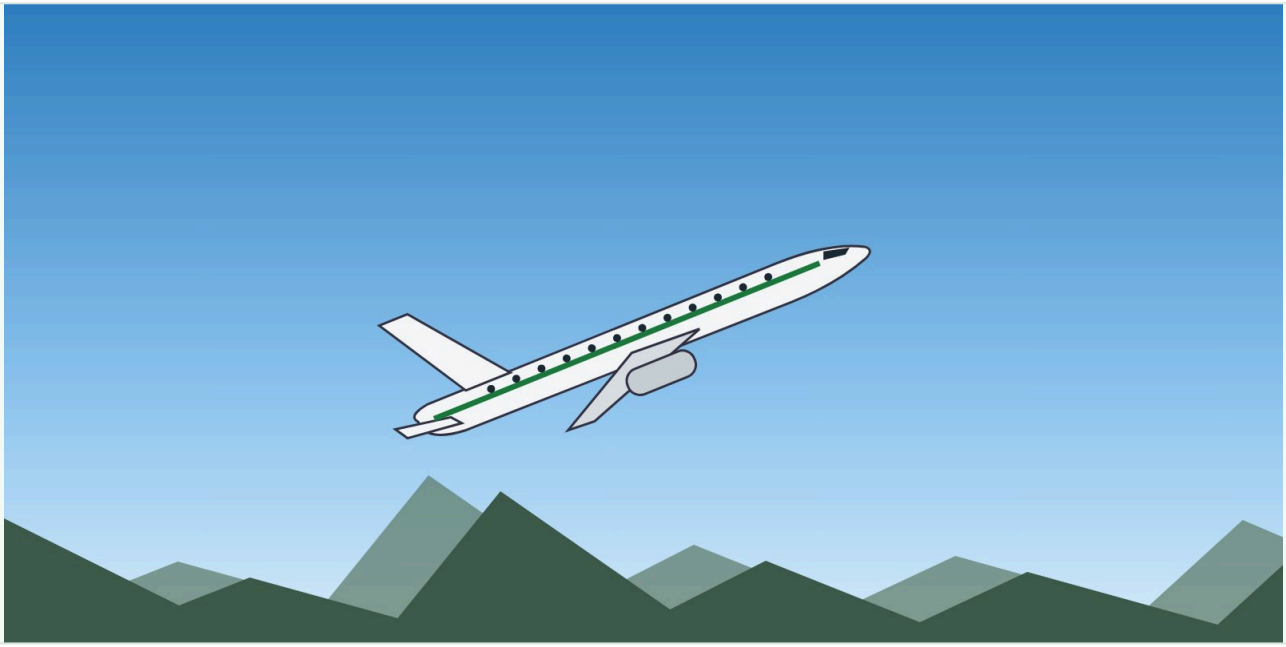
MODULE 2 · EGPWS AND THE ESCAPE MANOEUVRE

Lesson 06: The Escape Manoeuvre — by Fleet

Lesson 6 of 7 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Apply the company EGPWS recovery procedure for your fleet.
- Explain the reasons for each step.
- Complete the recovery and inform ATC.



The escape manoeuvre: maximum power, wings level, pitch to the stick shaker.

Company procedures

Fleet	Pilot flying	Pilot monitoring
Dash 8-Q400 Company SOP, EGPWS Recovery (Rev 02)	Calls **"CHECK POWER"**. Selects **GA** and disconnects the autopilot. Advances the power levers **to the detent**, rolls wings level and pitches aggressively to initiate the climb, respecting the stick shaker. Targets $\mathbf{V_{GA}}$. Once clear of terrain: establishes level flight and reconfigures the aircraft.	Confirms **NTOP** on the engine display and calls **"POWER SET"**. Monitors radio altimeter and vertical speed and informs the PF of performance and terrain clearance. Once clear: advises ATC — "(call sign) EGPWS recovery, new altitude / flight level ...".
Dash 8-Q200 Company SOP, Table 25 EGPWS recovery	Calls **"CHECK POWER"**. Selects **GA** and disconnects the AP. Advances the power levers to **MTOP**, rolls wings level and pitches aggressively to initiate the climb, responding to the stick shaker. Targets $\mathbf{V_{GA}}$. Once clear: establishes level flight and configures the aircraft.	Confirms **MTOP** and calls **"POWER SET"**. Monitors radio altimeter and vertical speed and informs the PF of performance and terrain clearance. Once clear: advises ATC of the EGPWS recovery and new altitude or flight level.

Boeing 737-800	Apply the **Terrain Avoidance** manoeuvre in the **QRH (Non-Normal Manoeuvres)** and the FCTM exactly as published. *Memory item — review it in your QRH before this course.*

Why each step matters

- **Maximum available power immediately** — the climb gradient depends on excess thrust. Turboprops respond quickly; jets need several seconds to spool up.
- **Autopilot off, wings level** — the lift vector must point up; a bank reduces the climb.
- **Pitch aggressively, respecting the stick shaker** — the best climb gradient is obtained close to the stall warning. Do not exceed it.
- **Do not change the configuration** during the escape unless your procedure says so. Retracting flaps or gear too early can reduce the climb capability.
- **The PM monitors** radio altimeter and vertical speed and calls the trend — the PF concentrates on flying.
- **Continue** until the warning stops and terrain clearance is assured, then level off, reconfigure and inform ATC.

PRACTISE IT

The escape manoeuvre is a last resort. It is practised in the simulator during recurrent training — so that, if needed, it happens instinctively.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Q400: CHECK POWER → GA, AP off → power levers to detent → wings level, pitch aggressively (stick shaker) → NTOP, POWER SET → VGA.
- Q200: the same sequence with MTOP.
- B737-800: QRH Terrain Avoidance manoeuvre — a memory item.
- After the escape: level off, reconfigure, tell ATC “EGPWS recovery”.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

During the Q400 EGPWS recovery, what does the PM confirm and call?

A. “Gear up”

B. NTOP on the engine display — “POWER SET”

C. “Flaps zero”

D. “Autopilot on”

Answer: B. The PM confirms NTOP on the engine display and calls “POWER SET”.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.